



POSITIVE VIBE HEALTH CLINIC

Lot 9 Extension Street, Suva, Fiji. | Phone – 3300389 / 9319762.

20.05.2024

Medical Report

Re: Tasisio 'Oukei Kava'uvea Joji Tuwai Lolesio
DOB: 16/1/2013

This Eleven -year-old boy was born to her mother, Mele Tuituu Lolesio on the 16th January 2013. Unfortunately, he was born with a congenital bone defect called Osteogenesis Imperfecta.

This is a condition with fragile bone and prone to fractures. Since that time, he has been admitted three times to the CWMH with fractures of the distal left femur and humerus.

Because of this congenital abnormality, frequent fractures, poor prognosis and limited ability to be looked after in Tonga, we elected for him to stay in Fiji for ongoing medical support and care.

He still is unable to walk but able to crawl around the floor comfortably.

Please let me know if there is anything specific you would like to add or if you need further assistance.

Your Sincerely,

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Dr. J Malani
Consultant Physician, MBChB, FRACP (Hon)



What is osteogenesis imperfecta in children?

Osteogenesis imperfecta (OI) is an inherited (genetic) bone disorder that is present at birth. It is also known as brittle bone disease. A child born with OI may have soft bones that break (fracture) easily, bones that are not formed normally, and other problems. Signs and symptoms may range from mild to severe.

There are at least 8 different types of the disease. The types vary greatly, both within and between types. They are based on the type of inheritance (see below), and signs and symptoms. These include findings on X-rays and other imaging tests. The OI types are as follows:

- **Type I.** Mildest and most common type. About 50% of all affected children have this type. There are few fractures and deformities
- **Type II.** Most severe type. A baby has very short arms and legs, a small chest, and soft skull. He or she may be born with fractured bones. He or she may also have a low birth weight and lungs that are not well developed. A baby with type II OI usually dies within weeks of birth
- **Type III.** Most severe type in babies who don't die as newborns. At birth, a baby may have slightly shorter arms and legs than normal and arm, leg, and rib fractures. A baby may also have a larger than normal head, a triangle-shaped face, a deformed chest and spine, and breathing and swallowing problems. These symptoms are different in each baby.
- **Type IV.** Symptoms are between mild and severe. A baby with type IV may be diagnosed at birth. He or she may not have any fractures until crawling or walking. The bones of the arms and legs may not be straight. He or she may not grow normally.
- **Type V.** Similar to type IV. Symptoms may be medium to severe. It is common to have enlarged thickened areas (hypertrophic calluses) in the areas where large bones are fractured
- **Type VI.** Very rare. Symptoms are medium. Similar to type IV.
- **Type VII.** May be like type IV or type II. It is common to have shorter than normal height. Also common to have shorter than normal upper arm and thighbones.
- **Type VIII.** Similar to types II and III. Very soft bones and severe growth problems.

What causes osteogenesis imperfecta in a child?

OI is passed on through the genes. The different types are passed on in different ways. The gene may be inherited from one or both parents. Or the gene can be passed on from an unexplained change (spontaneous mutation) of a gene.

Most babies with OI have a defect of one of two genes. These genes help in forming collagen. Collagen is a main part of connective tissue that connects and supports the whole body, including the bones. Because of the defect, there is not enough collagen. Or the collagen is abnormal.